

SWISS-VIET ECONOMIC FORUM (SVEF)

BUSINESS REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

(BRD)

SVEF Website & Event App Platform

Prepared by: IMT Software
Prepared for: Swiss-Viet Economic Forum (SVEF)
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Target deadline: before the Hanoi event, October 2026

1. Introduction

1.1. Purpose of the document

This document describes the Business Requirements for the project to rebuild/upgrade the Swiss-Viet Economic Forum (SVEF) Website and Event App platform. It is compiled based on: (1) the meeting minutes between IMT and SVEF dated 18 June 2026 (including the follow-up input from Mr. Ngoc, SVEF's dev representative, dated 29 June 2026); (2) the scope-summary document for SVEF Website & App features; and (3) a direct review of the structure and content of the current website at swissvieteconomicforum.org. This document serves as the basis for both parties to agree on scope, and as the foundation for the next steps: technical design (SRS/Technical Design), effort estimation, delivery planning, and product acceptance.

1.2. Intended audience

- SVEF Management Board – approves scope, feature priorities, and budget.
- SVEF technical team (represented by Mr. Ngoc) – validates requirements against the current system and advises on technology choices.
- IMT Software project team – analyzes, designs, develops, tests, and deploys the system.
- Other stakeholders (SVEF partners) – referenced when user-experience feedback is needed.

1.3. Terms & abbreviations

Term	Description
SVEF	Swiss-Viet Economic Forum – the system owner.
IMT	IMT Software – the implementation partner.
BRD	Business Requirement Document.
CMS	Content Management System.
SSO	Single Sign-On – login via Google/Microsoft.
NDA	Non-Disclosure Agreement.
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation (EU).
Subscriber	A user who registers to receive information only, without messaging/connection rights.
Partner / Member	Organizational partner/member (Institutional Member, Institutional Subscriber, Strategic Partner) or an individual (Individual Member).
Admin / Back-office	The internal administration system used by SVEF to operate the platform.
Front office	Features aimed at end users (subscribers/partners/attendees).
Back office	Internal administrative features for the organizing team.

2. Background and project objectives

2.1. Background

SVEF needs to prepare a new Website platform (either newly built or upgraded) ahead of the Hanoi event (expected October 2026), to both publish the event and serve as the organization's official promotional channel. Per the discussion on 29 June 2026, the SVEF technical team (Mr. Ngoc) confirmed that the current website (legacy platform) cannot be refactored and must be rebuilt from scratch using modern technology.

In parallel, SVEF also needs a platform/application to support event operations (Event App) with registration, scheduling, networking, speaker/sponsor management, and related features. For this rollout, the mobile app will NOT be

published to the App Store/Play Store; event-related features will be prioritized as a web app / integrated module within the Website.

2.2. Project objectives

- Have a new Website platform that is stable, professional, and ready before the Hanoi event (October 2026), serving both event publication/promotion and SVEF's brand image.
- Prioritize completion of two core feature groups: (1) Partner Management (membership, access permissions, company profile editing) and (2) Event Management (allowing partners to submit requests to publish their own events on the forum).
- Establish a dedicated test environment, a QA testing process, and a data-export process (Excel/CSV) from the legacy system before go-live.
- Ensure legal compliance regarding data security and storage between Switzerland/Europe and Vietnam (with reference to GDPR); sign an NDA between the parties before granting admin/confidential-data access.
- Lay a technical foundation (architecture, technology, data) that can scale to future features: Media/Press, AI chatbot/partner matching.

3. Project scope

3.1. In-scope

SVEF Website

- Rebuild the website using a modern JavaScript framework, rather than refactoring the legacy codebase.
- CMS for static content (About us, Activities, FAQ...) and dynamic content (News, Events, Resources/documents, Partner listings).
- Partner Management module: registration, classification (Institutional Subscriber / Institutional Member / Strategic Partner / Individual Member), profile editing, document/presentation/poster upload.
- Event Management module: forum-organized events and partner-proposed events (request form), displayed as Upcoming Events on the homepage.
- Account system: registration/login, one account managing multiple profiles (personal + company), SSO integration (Google, Microsoft).
- Role-based access control (subscriber/member/partner), enabling messaging/connections according to the corresponding permission level.
- Admin/back-office: manage activities, partners, memberships, media, and reports; export data (Excel/CSV) without exposing confidential information.
- Set up a Staging/Test environment fully separated from Production.
- Support the process of exporting data from the legacy system into the new system.

Event App / Event module

- Front-office features for attendees: Home/Dashboard, Explore/Discovery, Event Registration, My Schedule, Networking/Connect, Map/Navigate, Exhibitors/Sponsors, Notification, Profile.
- Back-office features for organizers: event registration management, pre-event planning, meetings program, event management, networking tools, post-event.
- Speaker Information Management: profiles, session linking, visibility control, import/export, search/filtering.
- Delivered as a web-based (responsive) solution; NOT published to the App Store/Play Store at this stage.

Future priority features (Future scope – not part of the first rollout)

- Media/Press: aggregating articles and coverage related to SVEF and its partners.
- AI/chatbot integration to support search and partner/company matching by industry.

- Integration of a domestic Vietnam payment gateway – low priority, pending the outcome of SVEF's discussion with banks' Open Banking APIs.
- Livestream/online meeting for events.

3.2. Out-of-scope

- Publishing the mobile application to the App Store / Google Play Store during this rollout (only monitoring policy feedback from Apple/Google to consider for a later phase).
- Integration of a domestic (Vietnam) payment gateway – only implemented once bank partner support for Open API is confirmed.
- Features under the "Future additional features" group (Media/Press, AI chatbot) in this first phase – to be placed in the backlog for later phases.

4. Stakeholders

Role	Organization/Representative	Key responsibilities
Project Owner	SVEF – Management Board	Approve scope, budget, priorities; sign the NDA; provide detailed requirements.
Technical point of contact (SVEF side)	Mr. Ngoc – SVEF Developer	Advise on technology, validate against the legacy system, guide architecture (multi-tenant, DB, etc.).
Implementation partner	IMT Software	Analyze, design, develop, test, deploy, and support operations.
End users	Subscriber / Member / Partner	Use front-office features: view information, register for events, update profiles, connect.
System administrator	SVEF – Operations Admin	Manage content, approve partners/events, generate reports via the back-office.

5. User roles and overall permission model

The current system distinguishes several user groups with different permission levels. A key requirement is that a single email/account must be able to manage multiple profiles (personal and company), instead of the current limitation of one profile per email.

Role	Description	Key permissions
Guest	A visitor who has not registered an account	View public content: About us, Activities, News, Events, Partners (public listing).
Subscriber	A user registered to receive information	Receives information only (newsletters, event notifications); no messaging/connection rights.
Individual Member	Individual member	Manages a personal profile; attends events; can link to a company profile (if any) under the same account.
Institutional Subscriber / Institutional Member	Organizational member	Manages a company profile, uploads documents/posters; attends events; access level depends on membership tier.
Strategic Partner	Strategic partner	Has full Institutional Member rights; given priority display; can submit requests to publish their own events on the forum; can access the partner database and send contact messages.
Admin / Back-office	SVEF administration team	Full control over content, partner, membership, media, event management, reporting, and data export.

6. Current-state analysis (As-Is)

6.1. Current website

The current website was reviewed at <https://swissvieteconomicforum.org/>, with a main menu structure comprising: Home, About us, Activities, Partners & Members, Events, News, Resources, Media, Contact us, along with a login area (Account/Login) leading to the Member Portal. The homepage currently includes the following content blocks: Our Main Missions, Our Activities, Latest News, Upcoming Events, Important Documents, Our Partners, New Joined Partners. The Partners & Members page supports filtering by Market (Switzerland/Vietnam/Europe/South East Asia/Global), Partnership Type (Institutional Subscriber/Institutional Member/Strategic partner), and Industry (Finance & Banking, Technology & Innovation, etc.).

The project team has identified the following issues with the current system:

- The design is not professional or consistent; UX/UI still has many limitations and defects.
- The source code of the legacy system was not shared by the previous developer and cannot be refactored.
- The infrastructure consists of only a single server, with no separate test/staging environment.
- A single email address cannot currently be used for both a personal profile and a company profile (individual member and institutional member) within one account.
- Permission separation between partner/member/subscriber is limited: subscribers only receive one-way information; only partners (Institutional Member, Strategic Partner) can send contact messages and access the partner database.
- There is no clear confirmation of code and data storage policy under Swiss/European law; data must not be transferred from Switzerland to Vietnam without a proper legal basis (with reference to GDPR).

6.2. Notes on Member Portal UI reference

A test account (imtsoft.test@gmail.com) was provided by SVEF for IMT to create a profile and directly review the Member Portal features on the current system — consistent with the meeting-note action item "IMT to create a profile on the SVEF website to review member-portal features." Logging in and interacting with the live site must be carried out manually by the IMT team in a browser (the current document-drafting tooling does not support login/form interaction on external websites); it is recommended that detailed screenshots of the Member Portal be added to the Appendix after this review, to serve as a basis for the new system's UI design.

7. Detailed business requirements – Website

7.1. CMS & content management

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-01	CMS	Allow Admin to manage static content (About us, Activities, FAQ, Contact, etc.) via a CMS, without requiring code changes.	High
BR-W-02	CMS	Allow Admin to manage dynamic content: News, Events, Resources/documents, Partner listings.	High
BR-W-03	CMS	Support multiple languages (at minimum bilingual EN/VN), consistent with the current website's structure (EN/VN switch).	Medium

7.2. Accounts, login & access control

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-04	Account	One account (one email) can manage multiple profiles (Individual Member and Institutional Member) — resolving the legacy system's limitation.	High

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-05	Account	Integrate Single Sign-On (SSO) via Google and Microsoft to streamline registration/login.	High
BR-W-06	Account	Role-based access control: Subscriber (information only) / Member / Partner (messaging, partner-database access).	High
BR-W-07	Account	Define the onboarding and approval workflow when a user registers a new account/profile.	High

7.3. Partner management

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-08	Partner	Improve the partner-registration form: attractive, easy to use, and clearly structured step by step.	High
BR-W-09	Partner	Allow partners to self-update their company profile (information, logo, industry, markets of operation, etc.).	High
BR-W-10	Partner	Allow partners to upload documents/presentations/posters — displayed as a dedicated tab within the profile page.	High
BR-W-11	Partner	Display a partner directory with filters by Market / Partnership Type / Industry (similar to the current Partners & Members page).	Medium
BR-W-12	Partner	Allow messaging/connections between members/partners according to their permission level.	Medium

7.4. Event management

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-13	Event	Build a request form allowing partners to self-register/propose their events to be published on the forum.	High
BR-W-14	Event	Admin approves/rejects partner-proposed events before they are publicly displayed.	High
BR-W-15	Event	Display both forum events and partner events on the homepage ("Upcoming Events" block).	High
BR-W-16	Event	Event detail page: information, time, location, registration link.	High

7.5. Admin / Back-office

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-17	Admin	Centrally manage activities, partners, memberships, media, and reports through a single admin tool.	High
BR-W-18	Admin	Export data (Excel/CSV) for reporting purposes, ensuring no confidential information (e.g., passwords) is exposed.	High
BR-W-19	Admin	Support importing/declaring data exported from the legacy system to support the migration phase before production.	High
BR-W-20	Admin	Grant admin-tool access to IMT only after the NDA between the parties has been signed.	High

7.6. Future expansion features (Backlog)

ID	Group	Requirement description	Priority
BR-W-21	Media/Press	Aggregate articles and coverage related to the forum and partners for display on the site.	Low (backlog)
BR-W-22	AI/Chatbot	Integrate AI/chatbot capability to support search and partner/company matching by industry.	Low (backlog)

8. Detailed business requirements – Event App / Event module

This section summarizes the "SVEF App Event Requirements" documents (the Vietnamese draft and the detailed English version). Features are grouped into Front office (attendees) and Back office (organizers), plus a group of in-depth Advanced Features.

8.1. Front office – Attendee-facing features

Module	Feature description
Home / Dashboard	List of events, quick access to key actions; personalized event feed; today's schedule at a glance.
Explore / Discovery	Event information; search for sessions/exhibitors/attendees by track, topic, or speaker; featured/trending content.
Event Registration	Personal/group registration; ticket booking and payment (paid & free events); registration confirmation and tickets; view/modify/cancel registration.
My Schedule	Session details (sessions, speaker bios, room details); visual calendar view; set reminders and notifications.
Online meeting / Livestream	Enable features and screens for online meetings/livestream events.
Networking / Connect	Attendee search and filtering; chat/messaging; connection requests; view mutual connections; QR code for contact exchange; meeting scheduling.
Map / Navigate	Venue map; session and booth locations; locate amenities (restrooms, food, exits).
Exhibitors / Sponsors	Exhibitor catalog; booth locations on the map; save favorites/bookmarks; schedule booth visits.
Notification	Session-start reminders, schedule changes, meeting confirmations, event announcements.
Community	Interaction between organizer and attendees via posts.
Profile	Personal information, interests/preferences, connection history, settings and privacy.

8.2. Back office – Organizer-facing features

Module	Feature description
Event Registration Management	Create/configure events (free/paid); registration types (personal/group); pricing tiers and payment options; registration capacity limits; early-bird and discount codes; approval workflows; attendee registration dashboard; export data/reports; send confirmation emails; manage waitlists; track payment status and reconciliation; process refunds.
Pre-event Planning	Event agenda and session browser; exhibitor/sponsor directory; venue information management; participant directory.
Meetings Program	Create networking profiles; browse and select potential meeting partners; send/receive meeting requests; accept/decline invitations; schedule one-on-one meetings; meeting feedback and ratings; reimbursement claim submission; algorithmic matching and scheduling.
Event Management	Personalized schedule builder; add sessions to calendar; real-time event updates and notifications; FAQ/help center.
Networking Tools	Connect with fellow attendees; view participant profiles; facilitate business collaborations.
Post-event	Event feedback submission; access to session recordings/materials (if applicable); follow-up with connections made.

8.3. Advanced Features

Networking Workflows

A structured system for facilitating professional connections between attendees through automated matching and meeting coordination, comprising:

- Double opt-in meeting system (both parties must agree).
- Profile-based attendee matching algorithm.
- Meeting request workflows: send → receive → accept/decline.
- Automated meeting scheduling; meeting reminders and notifications.
- Meeting feedback and ratings; reimbursement tracking for sponsored programs.

Interactive Floor Plans

- Digital venue mapping (halls, rooms, spaces).
- Exhibitor booth locations; session room indicators.
- Turn-by-turn navigation; amenity locations; meeting point markers.
- Search and filter functionality; zoom and pan controls; real-time location updates.

Speaker Information Management

- Create, update, and delete speaker profiles: name and title, organization/affiliation, biography, profile photo, contact information, social media links, areas of expertise/topics.
- Assign one or multiple speakers to a session; support multiple session types (single speaker presentations, panel discussions, workshops with co-facilitators); define speaker role per session (presenter, moderator, panelist).
- Speaker visibility controls: toggle profile visibility (public/private) and control display on the public event schedule/session details.
- Bulk import speakers via CSV; export the speaker list with associated sessions; template for standardized speaker data.
- Search and filter speakers by name, organization, topic, assigned sessions, expertise area, or confirmation status.
- Speaker communication: track confirmation status (invited/confirmed/declined); store internal notes; mark speakers as featured/keynote.
- Integration points: display on session details and speaker directory pages; administrative dashboard (statistics, unconfirmed-speaker lists, duplicate detection).
- Permissions: Event organizers (full CRUD access), Event collaborators (view/edit assigned speakers based on session permissions), Public (view published information only).

8.4. Gap analysis of the current App

Per the scope-summary document, the Home/Dashboard, My Schedule, Explore/Discovery, Online meeting, Event registration, Community, Notification, Networking/Connect, and Profile modules already have an initial reference UI ("what we already have"). Map/Navigate, Exhibitors/Sponsors, and integration of the domestic Vietnam payment gateway currently have NO existing UI and must be newly designed and developed; integrating the VN payment gateway is ranked as low priority.

Reference FOSS event-management platforms

The project team surveyed several free and open-source (FOSS) event-management platforms for feature and technology reference (not mandatory to reuse, purely for scope comparison):

Platform	Tech stack	Reference notes
Hi.Events	PHP / React	Personal & group registration, multi-tier ticketing, payment, QR check-in, REST API/webhooks, role-based access — missing a mobile app, live chat, session-based agenda builder.
Attendize	Laravel (PHP)	Registration, multiple ticket types, multi-gateway payment, data exports — missing session management, live chat, advanced analytics.
OSEM	Ruby on Rails	Event pages, detailed schedules, session management, talk/workshop proposals — payment processing is basic only, no mobile app.
Odoo Events	Python / PostgreSQL	Event pages, agendas, multi-level ticketing, ERP/marketing integration — missing group-registration flows, real-time chat.

Platform	Tech stack	Reference notes
Event Espresso	WordPress / PHP	Custom registration forms, mobile check-in, QR codes — missing live chat, session voting, analytics dashboard.

9. Consolidated permission matrix

The matrix below summarizes the main functional access level per role (X = has access, - = no access); details will be finalized during the technical design phase.

Function	Guest	Subscriber	Member	Partner	Admin
View public content (News/Events/Partners)	X	X	X	X	X
Receive information/newsletter	-	X	X	X	X
Register/manage personal & company profile	-	-	X	X	X
Upload documents/presentations/posters	-	-	-	X	X
Send messages/connections	-	-	Limited	X	X
Access partner database	-	-	-	X	X
Submit event-publish request to forum	-	-	-	X	X
Register for events	-	X	X	X	X
Manage content/CMS	-	-	-	-	X
Approve partners/events	-	-	-	-	X
Export data (Excel/CSV)	-	-	-	-	X

10. UI/UX reference

As required, the new system's UI will reference the information architecture and user flows of the current website (<https://swissvieteconomicforum.org/>), while improving overall aesthetics and UX/UI to a more professional standard. Reference sitemap from the current website:

Page / Area	Current content / functionality	Suggested improvement
Home	Our Main Missions, Our Activities, Latest News, Upcoming Events, Important Documents, Our Partners, New Joined Partners.	Keep the content-block structure; upgrade the visual design; optimize the Upcoming Events display (including partner events).
About us	Organization introduction.	Managed via CMS, no major content changes.
Activities	4 activity groups: Business Forums & Seminars, Trade Missions, Market Entry Support, Advocacy & Policy Influence.	Keep the same structure; improve presentation (tabs/accordion).
Partners & Members	Partner listing with filters by Market / Partnership Type / Industry / Institution Type; individual partner detail pages.	Add a documents/presentation/poster tab on the profile page; improve filter and search UX.
Events	Event listing, external registration link (e.g., zurich2026.svef.ch).	Integrate an internal event registration/management module; support both forum events and partner events.
News / Resources / Media	News, key documents, media library.	Managed via CMS; lay the groundwork for the future Media/Press feature.

Page / Area	Current content / functionality	Suggested improvement
Login / Member Portal	Login, role-based member features.	Redesign the registration/login flow, add SSO, support multiple profiles per account, improve the partner-registration form.
Contact us	Contact information, contact form.	Keep as-is, align with the new brand identity.

Note: SVEF has provided a test account (imtsoft.test@gmail.com) for the IMT team to log in directly, create a profile, and review in detail the screens within the current Member Portal (member registration, profile management, partner-only areas, etc.). Detailed UI review results (wireframes/screenshots) should be attached to the UI/UX Design & SRS document in the next step, once the design team has interacted with the live site in a browser.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

11.1. Technology & architecture

- Rebuild the entire system using a modern JavaScript framework (per the SVEF technical team's recommendation), rather than refactoring the legacy codebase.
- Database: PostgreSQL or MongoDB (per the SVEF technical team's recommendation).
- If speed of CMS delivery is prioritized, WordPress could be considered; however, this needs careful evaluation, as some specific admin workflows (complex partner/membership management) may exceed what plain WordPress can support.
- Architecture should support multi-tenancy on the user side for organizational members (each organization manages its own data/profile within the same platform).
- Prefer open-source or well-documented, widely used technology — since the legacy system's source code could not be handed over, a similar risk should be avoided.

11.2. Security & legal compliance

- Sign an NDA between SVEF and IMT before granting access to the admin tool and sharing confidential information/data.
- Comply with GDPR for user data related to Switzerland/Europe; do not transfer data from Switzerland to Vietnam without an appropriate legal basis.
- Exported data (Excel/CSV) must not expose sensitive information such as user passwords.
- Apply strict role-based access control for both front-office and back-office.

11.3. Environment & operations

- Set up a Test/Staging environment fully separated from Production (addressing the current system's "single server" limitation).
- Establish a clear QA testing process before go-live: build → test → review → deploy.
- SVEF is the party executing the production deployment; IMT provides technical support during the deployment process.
- Ensure the system is ready and stable before the Hanoi event (October 2026).

11.4. User experience

- Responsive design, well-optimized for both desktop and mobile browsers (since app-store publishing is not part of this rollout).
- Registration/forms (especially the partner-registration form) should be intuitive and minimize data-entry effort.
- Support bilingual English–Vietnamese content, consistent with the current website's structure.

12. Risks and assumptions

12.1. Risks

Risk	Impact level	Suggested mitigation
Legal risk when transferring user data between Switzerland and Vietnam (GDPR).	High	Seek legal consultation; apply a GDPR-compliant storage/data policy; clarify server location and data flow before implementation.
The legacy system's source code was never handed over, making it difficult to reconcile existing business logic.	Medium–High	Prioritize clear open-source/well-documented technology; clarify detailed requirements with SVEF before development; export all necessary data from the legacy system.
No separate test environment exists on the current infrastructure.	Medium	Set up an independent Staging/Test environment from the start of the project.
Inability to publish to the App Store/Play Store may affect the mobile user experience.	Medium	Deliver as a responsive web/PWA; continue monitoring Apple/Google policy feedback for a later phase.
Tight timeline ahead of the Hanoi event deadline (October 2026).	High	Prioritize development of the two core feature groups (Partner & Event) first; apply a phased delivery approach.

12.2. Assumptions

- SVEF will provide detailed requirements, data exports from the legacy system, and the test account on the agreed schedule.
- The NDA between the parties will be signed before IMT is granted access to the admin tool and confidential data.
- SVEF is responsible for contacting and confirming Open API payment-integration availability with banks (if the VN payment gateway is implemented).
- Publishing the application to the App Store/Play Store is not part of this rollout's committed timeline.

13. Plan & next steps

#	Task	Owner
1	Provide detailed requirements for each module.	SVEF
2	Create a profile on the current SVEF website to directly review Member Portal features.	IMT
3	Prepare and sign the NDA between the parties to enable admin-tool access.	SVEF prepares / IMT signs
4	Export data from the legacy system to support data migration.	SVEF
5	Prioritize development of the two feature groups: Partner Management and Event Management.	IMT
6	Build → Test → Review → Deploy to Production before the Hanoi event (October 2026).	IMT develops / SVEF executes the deployment

14. General acceptance criteria

- All features in the priority group (Partner Management, Event Management) work as described in Section 7 and are confirmed by SVEF through UAT (User Acceptance Testing).
- A single account can create and switch between multiple profiles (personal/company) without errors.
- SSO login (Google/Microsoft) succeeds and correctly synchronizes account information.
- The data-export function (Excel/CSV) works correctly and does not display confidential information.

- The system operates stably in Production before the Hanoi event date, having gone through the full build – test – review – deploy process on the Staging environment.
- The NDA has been signed and admin-tool access has been granted within the scope agreed by both parties.

15. Appendix – Reference sources

- IMT x SVEF meeting minutes dated 18 June 2026 (including the follow-up input from Mr. Ngoc, SVEF developer, dated 29 June 2026).
- Scope-summary document "SVEF App Event Requirements" (Vietnamese draft and detailed English version covering Front office/Back office/Advanced Features).
- Current website: <https://swissvieteconomicforum.org/> (menu structure, homepage, and Partners & Members page reviewed on 23 July 2026).
- Member Portal test account provided by SVEF: imtsoft.test@gmail.com (login and detailed review must be carried out manually in a browser by the project team).